Uliana Sirotina

ENGINEERING MANAGER | PEOPLE LEADERSHIP & HIRING | AI-ENABLED TEAMS

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Engineering Manager focused on people leadership, hiring and AI-enabled teams, with 10 years in software engineering. Hired 13 frontend engineers at Uberall and kept a squad at zero attrition through an acquisition and a reorganisation. At SoSafe, kept a team delivering through two rebuilds, a PM change and a scope shift, while making AI part of how the team works and staying ahead of how fast the tooling changes.

Experience

Engineering Team Lead (EM scope: line manager of 5) Apr. 2024 - present
SoSafe SE | Remote

Promoted from Senior Frontend Engineer to Team Lead within 4 months. Lead a cross-functional squad of 5 engineers (frontend, backend, fullstack) owning the Customer and User domains; 8 engineers led over 2 years, through two team rebuilds.

- Rebuilt the team from merged parts (new PM, new designer, two developer pairs from different squads) and distributed ownership until holding only 4 of 16 epics personally.
- Led the team through a loss of its PM, a scope change to maintenance mode and two engineer resignations in the same week, while keeping delivery on track across three fronts: accessibility tooling, the self-service launch and customer domain fixes.
- **Developed people through structured feedback:** coached a senior engineer out of underperformance in 7 months, moved a QA engineer into a junior backend role and promoted him to mid-level in the next cycle; managed one exit end to end, from calibration to separation
- Ran end-to-end hiring for 2 engineers and trained 3 colleagues to interview (including one first-time hiring manager) and authored hiring-process improvement proposals.
- Built an **AI skill for calibration** and structured performance feedback, aligned to SoSafe's Engineering Levels Framework and reused by managers across the company.
- **Made the team an early AI adopter** (first to volunteer for tool trials, 2-day AI hackathon, AI now fully rolled out).
- Connected the design system to Claude Design with the design system designer, enabling engineers (including backend) to design full UI/UX flows despite limited designer capacity; personally designed a Sales-facing test customer creation flow.
- Core team behind the customer self-service launch, owning delivery of the onboarding flow on our platform; self-service is now available for all low-to-mid tier customers, freeing CS from technical support to focus on quality consulting.
- Investigated why language handling was so complex and which parts of our architecture it touched, then planned and implemented the move from 2-digit to 4-digit language codes in our team, which owns the User and Customer objects; pushed back on shortcuts proposed by other teams with an estimate of ~2 months of rework per team across 5 teams.
- **Engineering partner for CS, CRM and Solution Engineering** on the internal platform: Salesforce integration, product provisioning and usability of internal UX flows (demo creation, pricing & packaging); led the Claude-assisted investigation of a pricing incident affecting hundreds of customers and the follow-up provisioning audit with Product Analytics that sized a seven-to-eight-figure ARR impact.
- Introduced sprint-based planning, velocity tracking and explicit prioritisation; deliberately halved sprint load to reinvest capacity into architecture, technical planning, bug triage and pairing.

Senior Frontend Engineer Feb. 2023 - Mar. 2024
Garden.io GmbH | Berlin, Germany

- **Shipped free-tier onboarding on the fixed release date.** Designed and implemented the customer onboarding flow for the product's free tier launch, covering a gap found late in planning.
- Built product features in TypeScript, React, React Query and styled-components, with smaller improvements to the API.

Senior Frontend Engineer Apr. 2022 - Jan. 2023
Adjust GmbH | Berlin, Germany

- Restructured the team's API error handling and separated Sentry reporting from the shared company project, improving signal quality for frontend issues.

- Introduced a bug board and triage flow for the team.

(Squad Lead) Engineering Manager Aug. 2020 - Mar. 2022
Uberall GmbH | Berlin, Germany

People lead for a cross-functional squad of 6 owning review management (aggregating Google Maps, TripAdvisor and partner reviews into one tool), and frontend hiring manager for the engineering department.

- **Hired 13 frontend engineers across all teams.** As the department's frontend hiring manager, built the frontend hiring process and its documentation, and trained other engineers to interview.
- **Held the team together through an acquisition, a reorganisation and repeated process changes:** zero attrition and unbroken delivery cadence.
- Promoted one engineer to Senior, and mentored a backend engineer from another team into their first Team Lead role, advocating for them with leadership to make it happen.
- Introduced Scrum from scratch to balance a defect-prone multi-partner ingestion pipeline against new product delivery: two-week sprints with capacity deliberately reserved for incremental fixes, so quality improved steadily without pausing feature work.

Frontend Engineer Aug. 2019 - Jul. 2020
Uberall GmbH | Berlin, Germany

- Developed features using ReactJS, Redux, React-Query, and Less, conducted code reviews.
- Improved onboarding documentation and process in the Engineering department.
- Led the creation of UI-component library (Theme UI, ReactJS).
- Organised and ran the Frontend Chapter meetings.

Frontend Engineer (joined as working student) Sep. 2016 - Jul. 2019
Searchmetrics GmbH | Berlin, Germany

- Created and maintained UI-kit (component library) - Storybook, ReactJS.
- Mentored frontend working students.

Education

M. Sc. Computer Science 2015 - 2018
Technical University of Berlin, Major: Media design and Human-computer interaction

Diploma, Cognitive Systems 2009 - 2014
Russian State University for the Humanities

Skills & Tools

People leadership: Line management, Performance management, Career development, Promotions, Managed exits
Hiring: Hiring process design, Interviewer training, Hiring decisions
Ways of working: Scrum, Sprint planning, Incident communication, Documented processes
AI: Claude, Claude Design, ChatGPT, AI skills and agents, team adoption and rollout
Technical background: TypeScript, React, Node.js, design systems | Led teams with Java/Kotlin backends

Additional info

2022 - Mentor Move - career and relocation mentor for specialists moving into European tech roles: CV reviews, mock interviews, coaching

Languages: English (C1), German (C1), Russian (native)
Unrestricted work permit, Germany